Pearson Edexcel GCSE (9–1)

Wednesday 15 May 2026
Morning (Time: 1 hour 20 minutes)

PAPER REFERENCE
1HI0/11

History

PAPER 1: Thematic study and historic environment

Option 11: Medicine in Britain, c1250–present and The British sector of the Western Front, 1914–18: injuries, treatment and the trenches

Sources Booklet

Do not return this Booklet with the question paper.

Sources for use with Section A.

This booklet contains Source A and Source B for use with Question 2 on the question paper.

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Sources for use with Section A.

Source A: A private diary entry from an RAMC surgeon at a Casualty Clearing Station (CCS) near the Somme, August 1916.

Gas gangrene is claiming too many of our men with deep shrapnel wounds. Today we fully implemented the Carrel-Dakin method of chemical wound irrigation. By inserting rubber tubes directly into the deep tissue, we can flush the wound continuously with a sterilized salt solution. It is labor-intensive and requires the solution to be mixed fresh, but the reduction in severe infections and subsequent amputations is already noticeable.

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Sources for use with Section A (continued).

Source B: An official British Army medical directive issued to RAMC units in late 1915.

URGENT: PREVENTATIVE MEASURES FOR TETANUS. It is strictly ordered that all stretcher bearers and medical personnel at Regimental Aid Posts must ensure the immediate administration of anti-tetanus serum to any casualty presenting with shrapnel or gunshot wounds. The high concentration of manure in the French soil has led to unacceptable mortality rates from tetanus infection. Immediate injection is mandatory before evacuation down the line.

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